

A Shoot from a Felled Stump: The Conceded Throne

Menuḥah as Terminus, the Monarchy as Concession, and the Roots of the Jewish Messiah in the Hebrew Bible

Mohammad F. Islam, PhD¹

¹ Independent researcher · ORCID 0009-0003-1671-0664 · Correspondence: islammm@alumni.iu.edu

This article argues that the Hebrew Bible states the terminus of its own promise as a state rather than as an event, names that state in a single root-field, records it as delivered by non-royal agents and as subsequently unoccupied, and locates the failure of occupancy in the receiver rather than in any deficiency of the gift. It further argues that the royal and future-royal material stands in a determinate relation to that terminus: not as its content but as a conceded means toward it, granted under an explicitly itemized protest and escalated at each failure of the preceding grant. The argument is constrained to the Hebrew Bible; where other material would ordinarily supply a warrant, the article locates the corpus's own. The instrument is a single removability criterion, stated formally and then shown to be one the corpus applies to itself: a content is substantive if the corpus states it in a passage naming no eschatological figure and no dated event. Under that criterion six substantive contents survive the removal of the royal figure, including the terminus; what does not survive is the layer of gathering, rebuilding, and restoration, which the corpus subordinates grammatically to a purpose clause whose object is the state. The conclusion is not that the royal material is unreal or late, but that the corpus itself files it as road rather than destination. Three falsification criteria are stated with their present null results, and one unexecuted concordance explicitly caps the article's terminal strength.

KEYWORDS *menuḥah*; sabbath; Deuteronomistic History; monarchy; 1 Samuel 8; royal ideology; Isaiah 6:9-10; hardening; Jeremiah 8:8

1. Introduction, and a debt paid first

1.1 What is and is not new here

The observation that the Hebrew Bible says the rest was given and also says it was not entered is **not new and is not claimed here as new**. Gerhard von Rad set the problem in 1933 in the essay that gave this article half its title, and the seam he identified is the one this article works: Joshua 21:44 states that the LORD gave Israel rest on every side, 1 Kings 8:56 states at the dedication of the temple that the rest has been given, and Psalm 95:11 states that they did not enter it. Any reader of the Deuteronomistic material meets that tension, and a substantial literature has met it since.

What is offered here is a sorting rather than a discovery. The claim is that the tension von Rad located is not an unresolved residue of the tradition but a **structural feature with a determinate direction**, and that the direction becomes visible

once one asks a different question of the material: not *when* the rest arrives, but **what kind of object it is**, and therefore **what kind of relation the royal and future-royal material bears to it**. The answer this article defends is that the terminus is a state, that a state is entered rather than delivered, and that the whole apparatus of gathering, restoration, and awaited kingship is therefore filed by the corpus as a means toward an object it cannot itself constitute.

1.2 What this article is not doing

It is not proposing a compositional history. The escalation sequence set out in section 6 is ordered by **content**, each stage answering the failure of the one beneath it, and no dating is claimed for it beyond the narrative sequence the corpus itself supplies for its first three stages.

It is not resolving the source-critical question about the monarchy. The classical division of 1 Samuel 8 through 12 into pro-monarchic and anti-monarchic strands remains available and this article takes no position on it. **What it does claim is that the**

final form's preservation of both is itself the datum, and that a redaction which retains an itemized indictment of kingship on the same scroll as the royal psalms is doing something a reader should account for rather than dissolve.

It is not an argument about the truth of any expectation, nor a prediction about any arrival. Section 12 states explicitly why nothing in the argument depends on either.

2. Method

2.1 The single-corpus constraint

Every load-bearing claim in this article rests on the Hebrew Bible. This is a methodological constraint and not a claim that other bodies of material are false or uninformative. Its purpose is testability: **a reading that must reach outside its corpus to stand cannot be checked inside it**, and a reader with a Hebrew Bible and a concordance should be able to test every claim made here without acquiring a second library.

2.2 The removability criterion

The instrument is a single question. **Strip the singular-figure framing from a passage and ask what proposition remains.** Formally: a passage may be *indexed* to a figure, to a dated event, or to a state. Stripping is the deletion of the figure-and-event clause and the reading of whatever predicate survives. A content is substantive under the criterion if the corpus states it in a passage naming no eschatological figure and no dated event.

Two calibration cases fix the operation before it is used to decide anything.

Micah 6:8 carries no figure-clause and no temporal condition, so stripping is the identity operation and the proposition stands unchanged: *'asot mishpat we-'ahavat ḥesed we-ḥasnea' lekhet 'im 'elohekha*.

Ezekiel 37:21 reads *'ani loqeaḥ 'et benei Yisra'el... we-qibbaṣti 'otam*, where the gathering is the main verb and the whole content, so deletion leaves no predicate at all.

2.3 The criterion is one the corpus applies to itself

The criterion is not imposed from outside. **Deuteronomy 30:11-14** asserts that the commandment is not hidden, not in heaven, and not beyond the sea, *ki qarov 'eleykha ha-davar me'od, be-fikha u-vilvavkha la-'asoto*, which is a claim that the content is reachable with no intermediary standing between hearer and act. **Micah 6:8** performs the strip and prints the residue. **Jeremiah 9:22-23** performs it by subtraction, striking wisdom, might, and riches and leaving knowledge of God. **Deuteronomy 10:12-13** answers the question of requirement in five infinitives with no eschatology among them.

The unit of application is the pericope, and **Deuteronomy 30 marks its own pericope boundary**, which forestalls the objection that the criterion cuts a continuous speech arbitrarily. Verses 1 through 10 stand under *we-hayah ki yavo'u 'aleykha kol ha-devarim ha-'elleh*, a future-perfect frame carrying the gathering and the return. Verse 11 turns on *ki* into *ha-mišwah ha-zot 'asher 'anokhi mešawwekha ha-yom*, and *ha-yom* recurs at 30:15, 16, 18, and 19. **Two temporal frames, marked lexically by the text, in one chapter.**

3. The terminus is a state, and the corpus names it

3.1 Four roots at the rest-position, none of them a fatigue word

The account of creation closes not on a seventh act of the same kind as the six but on a cessation: *wa-yikhal 'elohim ba-yom ha-shevi'i mela'kto 'asher 'asah, wa-yishbot ba-yom ha-shevi'i* (Gen 2:2). The image in *šbt* is the hand coming off the work.

Three further roots occupy the same position elsewhere and none of the four denotes recuperation.

Table 1 | The four rest-roots, their subjects, and their distinct offices

Root	Sense	Subject	Image and locus
šbt	cessation	the worker	the hand coming off the work; Gen 2:2
nwl	settlement	the mover	the alighting that stays; <i>wa-tanaḥ ha-tevah</i> , Gen 8:4
šqt	undisturbedness	the land	quiet from outside molestation; the refrain <i>wa-tishqoṭ ha-'areš</i> , Judg 3:11, 3:30, 5:31, 8:28
rg'	relief	the person	repose at the end of a walk; <i>u-miš'u margoa' le-nafshotekhem</i> , Jer 6:16

Cessation, settlement, quiet, relief: four distinct offices with four distinct subjects. They are not synonyms and the article does not treat them as such.

3.2 The promise's own terminus is named in the second of these roots

- **Deut 12:9**, *ki lo' va'tem 'ad 'attah 'el ha-menuḥaḥ we-'el ha-naḥalah*, with 12:10's *we-heniaḥ lakhem mi-kol 'oyevyekhem*.

- **Josh 21:44**, *wa-yanah YHWH lahem mi-saviv*; repeated 22:4, 23:1.
- **1 Kgs 8:56**, *barukh YHWH 'asher natan menuḥah le-'ammo Yisra'el*.
- **1 Chr 22:9**, of the temple-builder before his birth, *'ish menuḥah yihyeh*.
- **Ezek 37:14**, the ingathering's own terminal clause, *we-hinnaḥti 'etkhem 'al 'admatkhem*.
- **Ps 95:11**, *'im yevo'un 'el menuḥati*.

Six sites in the settling-root. Beside them stand further state-descriptions from other roots: **Isaiah 11:9's** *ki male'ah ha-'areš de'ah 'et YHWH ka-mayim la-yam mekhassim*, a state description with **no agent in the clause**, and **Isaiah 2:4's** *lo' yilmedu 'od milḥamah*, a cessation in narrative form.

3.3 Four consequences, each checkable

First, the terminus is named rather than inferred. It has a lexeme, the lexeme is a state-word, and it is cognate with the word at the terminal position of the creation account.

Second, it is delivered by agents who are not royal and not future. Joshua at 21:44. Solomon announcing it as already given at 1 Kings 8:56. The Judges refrain delivering *šqt* four separate times under four ordinary deliverers, for forty and eighty years at a stretch. **A terminus repeatedly delivered by ordinary agents is not a terminus requiring an extraordinary one.**

Third, it is recorded as not entered, at Psalm 95:11, of the same object and in the same vocabulary.

Fourth, and this binds section 3 to section 4, the arrival-question and the entry-diagnosis stand in one psalm. **Psalm 95:7** reads *ki hu' 'eloheyinu, wa-'anaḥnu 'am mar'ito we-šo'n yado; ha-yom 'im be-qolo tishma'u*, and 95:11 four verses later gives the non-entry. **Flock-relation, hearing condition, unoccupied rest, in that order.**

3.4 The exile is accounted in unentered rest

2 Chronicles 36:21 accounts the exile's duration not in years served but in sabbaths owed: the land lay desolate *'ad rašetah ha-'areš 'et shabbetoteha*, on Leviticus 26:34-35 and 43, *'az tiršeh ha-'areš 'et shabbetoteha* because it did not rest in your sabbaths while you dwelt on it. The national catastrophe is priced in the currency of the terminus.

4. The failure is located at the receiver

Five passages, three books, one direction, with the Exodus 20:8 guard beside them in a fourth. **Not one attributes the non-entry to an absent, withheld, delayed, or reserved terminus.**

Deuteronomy 29:3. *We-lo' natan YHWH lakhem lev la-da'at we-'eynayim lir'ot we-'oznayim lishmoa' 'ad ha-yom ha-zeh*. The deliverable is delivered; forty years of signs are recited immediately before. The receiving organ is stated as not given.

Isaiah 6:9-10. The commission is a commission to deliver into non-reception, and says so at the moment of commissioning: *šim'u shamo'a' we-'al tavinu*, then *hashmen lev ha-'am ha-zeh we-'oznav hakhbed we-'eynav hash'a', pen yir'eh... wa-shav we-rafa' lo*. Verse 11's *'ad matay* receives a duration rather than a resolution.

Isaiah 42:19-20. *Mi 'iwwer ki 'im 'avdi, we-ḥeresh ke-mal'akhi 'eshlah*, closing on *paqoaḥ 'oznayim we-lo' yishma'*. **The corpus places its own messenger in the category**, which forecloses the polemical use of the motif.

Deuteronomy 8:12-14 supplies the mechanism, and the danger condition is prosperity rather than hardship: *pen to'khal we-sava'ta... we-ram levavekha we-shakhaḥta*. A state entered and unnoticed is, to the one standing in it, indistinguishable from a state never given. **Exodus 20:8** guards the same position with the one imperative of memory in the Decalogue, *zakhōr 'et yom ha-shabbat*.

Jeremiah 6:16 answers the strongest objection to this section, which is that two of the four texts describe an organ *not given* and one has the ears *made* heavy, so the deficit looks imposed rather than incurred. In Jeremiah nothing is withheld and nothing is made heavy: the paths are *netivot 'olam*, already standing; the instruction is to ask and to walk; the terminus is *margoa' le-nafshotekhem*; **and the verse closes wa-yomeru lo' nelekh**, and they said, we will not walk in it. Deuteronomy 30:19's *u-vaḥarta ba-ḥayyim* is the same shape from the other side.

The corpus carries both an unfurnished organ and a declined offer, and reconciles neither. What it carries nowhere is a withheld terminus.

5. The monarchy is granted as a concession, and the grant is itemized

The final form prints the whole transaction, in sequence, with every stage labelled.

Box 1 | The concession engine, in the corpus's own sequence

#	Stage	Locus
1	Refusal; only God is king	Judg 8:23
2	Demand for a visible sovereign	1 Sam 8:5
3	Diagnosis; the reign rejected, not ended	1 Sam 8:7
4	Itemized bill, with the unanswered-outcry clause	1 Sam 8:11-18
5	Refusal to hear, then grant, priced in anger	8:19, 8:22; Hos 13:11

The refusal, Judges 8:22-23: *lo' 'emshol 'ani bakhem we-lo' yimshol beni bakhem, YHWH yimshol bakhem*.

The demand and its content, 1 Samuel 8:5: *simah lanu melek* *le-shoftenu ke-khol ha-goyim*. Judges already existed and the request replaces them; the demand is for a **visible** sovereign of the neighbours' kind, which is a request about form and not about function.

The diagnosis, 8:7: *ki 'oti ma'asu mi-melokh 'aleyhem*. The clause does not say the reign ended, was suspended, or was transferred. It says the reign was rejected **as theirs to be under**, which leaves the sovereignty untouched and changes only its acceptance and therefore its visibility.

The prosecution, in advance and itemized, 8:11-18: sons, daughters, fields, vineyards, olive groves, a tenth of the seed and of the flock, the best young men, the donkeys, *we-'attem tihyu lo la-'avadim*. And the clause that converts warning into contract, 8:18: *u-ze'aqtem ba-yom ha-hu'... we-lo' ya'aneh YHWH 'etkhem ba-yom ha-hu'*.

The refusal to hear, 8:19, then the grant at 8:22. **The price**, Hosea 13:11: *'etten lekha melek be-'appi we-'eqqah be-'evrati*.

And **the statute opens on the demand**: Deuteronomy 17:14, *we-'amarta 'asimah 'alay melek ke-khol ha-goyim 'asher sevivotay*. The law of the king regulates a thing conditioned on being asked for. 1 Samuel 12:17-19 has the people name the asking an evil after the fact.

6. The throne is conferred, not owned, and the corpus says so three times in one book

1 Chronicles 29:23, *wa-yeshev Shelomoh 'al kisse' YHWH le-melek*. **1 Chronicles 28:5**, the chosen son *la-shevet 'al kisse' malkhut YHWH 'al Yisra'el*. **2 Chronicles 9:8**, *le-titkha 'al kis'o le-melek la-YHWH 'eloheykha*, to set you on **His** throne as king **for the LORD your God**.

Three occurrences, one book, one construction, and in the third the beneficiary of the kingship is named as God rather than the

king. **An honorific reading does not survive being paired with an explicit assertion of ownership by the honoree's own predecessor**, and 1 Chronicles 29:11's *lekha YHWH ha-mamlakah* stands twelve verses before the seating.

Two further conferrals belong here. **Psalms 110:1**'s *ne'um YHWH la-'adoni shev li-mini*, where the seat is offered and the offerer is named. And **Psalms 110:4**'s *'attah khohen le-'olam 'al divrati Malki-Şedeq*, which patterns the royal priesthood on the Jerusalemite king-priest of Genesis 14:18 and **not on Aaron**. That the *şedeq* element is a local dynastic form and not an isolated anomaly is supplied by the corpus itself: **Joshua 10:1** names the king of Jerusalem at the conquest *'Adoni-Şedeq*.

The subordination of the occupant is likewise explicit. Deuteronomy 17:18-20 requires the king to write out a copy of the teaching and not to turn aside, with the purpose clause *le-vilti rum levavo me-'ehaw*; and a guard erected against an impossibility is not a guard. 2 Chronicles 26:16 and 32:25 supply the executions in the same idiom. **2 Samuel 7:14** supplies a limit inside its own sonship clause, *we-hokhahtiv be-shevet 'anashim*, while 7:15 bars the withdrawal, so discipline falls on the occupant and the grant is not revoked. **Psalms 2:7** dates the sonship in one adverb, *'ani ha-yom yelidtikha*, which is the formula of a coronation day.

Ezekiel 34:24 states the two roles in one verse and distinguishes them: *wa-'ani YHWH 'ehyeh lahem le-'elohim, we-'avdi Dawid nasi' be-tokham*.

7. The escalation sequence

The grant is issued once. The kings then fail, repeatedly and on the record. **The corpus does not withdraw the concession and does not point back to the terminus. It re-issues the concession at higher intensity**. Eight stages are present in the corpus, ordered here by content.

Box 2 | The eight stages, ordered by content

#	Stage	Locus
1	Refusal	Judg 8:23
2	Concession	1 Sam 8
3	Permanence, withdrawal barred	2 Sam 7:12-16, 7:15
4	Cosmic vocabulary	Ps 2:7; 45:7; 110:1
5	Throne-name	Isa 9:5
6	Regrowth after felling	Isa 11:1, from a <i>geza'</i>
7	The split into two	Zech 4:14; 6:13
8	Celestial conferral	Dan 7:13-14, <i>yehiv</i>

Stages 1 to 3 stand in narrative sequence in the corpus. Stages 4 to 8 are ordered logically, each answering the failure of the one beneath it; no compositional dating is claimed.

One, refusal, Judges 8:23. **Two, concession**, 1 Samuel 8. **Three, permanence**, 2 Samuel 7:12-16, where the thing conceded under protest becomes unrevokable and 7:15 bars the withdrawal. **Four, cosmic vocabulary**, Psalm 2:7, Psalm 45:7's *kis'akha 'elohim 'olam wa-'ed* addressed to the king, Psalm 110:1's seat at the right hand. **Five, the throne-name**, Isaiah 9:5's *pele' yo'eš 'el gibbor 'avi 'ad sar shalom*. **Six, regrowth after felling**, Isaiah 11:1's *hoṭer mi-geza' Yishay*, a shoot from a felled **stump**, the promise re-issued over the remains of the first grant. **Seven, the split**, Zechariah 4:14's *shene bene ha-yiṣhar* and 6:13's *we-'aṣat shalom tihyeh beyn shenehem*, where a counsel of peace **between them both** requires two parties. **Eight, celestial conferral**, Daniel 7:13-14, dominion *yehiv*, given.

The first three stand in narrative sequence in the corpus itself. **No compositional dating is claimed for the remaining five**, since the canonical arrangement is not the compositional order and the dating of several is contested.

The structural result. Section 4 located the failure at the receiver; section 3 established the terminus as a state; and a state is entered rather than delivered. **No enlargement of the agent addresses a deficiency in the entering.** The sequence is therefore not a development toward an answer but the same category substitution performed eight times at rising magnitude: a delivery solution offered to an entry problem.

8. The tree: stump, root, and shoot

Job 14:7-9 divides the felled tree into three parts and rules on each in three successive clauses. *Ki yesh la-'eš tiqwah*, 'im yikkaret 'od yaḥalif — the tree **has hope**. 'Im yazqin ba-'areš *shorsho*, u-ve-'afar *yamut giz'o* — the root persists, **and the stump dies in the dust**. *Me-reaḥ mayim yafriah* — and the trigger is the **scent** of water already in the ground.

Isaiah 11:1 names two sources and Job has already ruled on one of them. *Hoṭer mi-geza' Yishay* and *neṣer mi-shorashaw yifreḥ* are not one image stated twice: stump and root, and Job 14:8 says which of the two dies. The corpus states both without reconciling them.

The consequence is a distinction the corpus itself draws elsewhere. **The shoot is real and the tree's hope is real.** What the corpus fences is a **location**: Jeremiah 2:27's 'omerim *la-'eš*

'avi 'attah, and Habakkuk 2:19's *hoy 'omer la-'eš haqīṣah*, 'uri le-'even *dumam...* *we-khol ruaḥ 'eyn be-qirbo*, woe to him who says to the wood **Arise**, for there is no breath in it at all — answered one verse later by *wa-YHWH be-heykhal qodsho*, *has mi-panaw kol ha-'areš*. **A thing told to get up, which has no breath, against one already present who requires silence rather than summoning.**

Two objects are denoted by 'eš here and the article marks the shift rather than trading on it. At Job 14 and Isaiah 11 it is a **felled tree**, a living root system with a dead crown. At Jeremiah 2 and Habakkuk 2 it is **carved timber**, a manufactured article with no root at all. The contrast between them is what makes the first legible.

Isaiah 6 closes on the same image, and the placement is worth noting: after the commission into non-reception and after 'ad *matay*, 6:13 ends 'asher be-shalleket *maṣṣevet bam*, *zera' qodesh maṣṣavtah*, the holy seed is its stump — seven chapters before the shoot of 11:1.

9. What the corpus preserves

9.1 It indicts its own scribes and says the teaching is still in hand

Jeremiah 8:8. 'Eykhah *toimeru ḥakhamim 'anahnu we-torat YHWH 'ittanu*, 'aken hinneh *la-sheqer 'asah 'eṭ sheqer soferim*. The referent of *soferim* is disputed between manuscript copyists and a teaching class, and the parsing of 'asah is likewise disputed; **this article takes no side, because both readings place the fault at the carriage and neither places it at the deposit**, and *we-torat YHWH 'ittanu* stands in the same sentence under either. **Ezekiel 22:26** and **Malachi 2:7-8** carry the same shape at the priestly office.

Deuteronomy 4:2 and 13:1's *lo' tosifu...* *we-lo' tigre'u* are worth noting in this connection: a prohibition on adding and subtracting is issued where adding and subtracting are anticipated.

9.2 It preserves its own contradictions, and this is a habit rather than a residue

Ten pairs, each stated on both ends by the corpus, resolved by neither.

Table 2 Ten pairs stated on both ends by the corpus and resolved by neither	
Barred or subordinated	Seated or restored
Deut 23:4-7, the Moabite and Ammonite barred to the tenth generation	Ruth 4:18-22, the line sealed through Ruth <i>ha-Mo'aviyyah</i> ; 1 Kgs 14:21, Na'amah <i>ha-'Ammonit</i>
Jer 22:24-30, the signet plucked from Coniah, <i>'ariri</i>	Hag 2:23, the signet restored to Zerubbabel, his grandson at 1 Chr 3:17
Isa 49:3, the servant named Israel	Isa 49:6, the servant distinguished from the tribes, four verses later
Jer 7:22 with 1 Sam 15:22, Hos 6:6, Isa 1:11	Ezek 40-48, the offerings restored, the prince's six lambs at 46:4
Judg 8:23 and 1 Sam 8:7, kingship refused and named rejection	1 Chr 29:23, the king seated on the throne of the LORD
1 Sam 8:11-18, the itemized prosecution	Ps 45:7, the king's throne addressed as <i>'elohim</i>
Num 25:12-13 and Ezek 44:15, a perpetual Aaronide priesthood and its exclusion clause	Ps 110:4, a perpetual priesthood on a non-Aaronide and pre-Israelite order
Deut 7:1-3 and Exod 34:15-16, <i>lo' titḥatten bam</i>	The ancestry seated through those nations in seven instances, §9.3
Job 14:8, the stump dies in the dust	Isa 11:1, the shoot comes from the stump
Ps 23:1, the king says <i>YHWH ro'i</i> ; 2 Sam 5:2 sets him over <i>'ammi</i>	Ezek 34:24, <i>'avdi Dawid nasi'</i> while God remains <i>le-'elohim</i> , the flock <i>šo'ni</i> throughout

A tradition operating by deletion does not preserve its own prosecution ten times.

9.3 The line is seated through the standing bar, and the bar is quoted at the breach

Against Deuteronomy 7:1-3 the corpus runs the ancestry through the barred nations in seven instances across three registers. **Four stand inside the Davidic line** as Ruth 4:18-22 enumerates it: Judah at its head with the Canaanite wife whose sons are **not** the line, the line routing instead through Tamar, **whose origin the corpus does not supply**; Boaz through Ruth; David through the household of *'Uriyyah ha-Ḥitti*; and Solomon, whose successor at 1 Kings 14:21 is the son of Na'amah. **Three stand outside it**: Ishmael through Hagar *ha-Miṣrit*, Joseph through Asenath *bat Poṭi-Fera' khohen 'On*, and Moses through Zipporah and *ha-'ishah ha-Kushit*, **where the objectors are rebuked and the marriage is not** (Num 12).

1 Kings 11:2 quotes the prohibition verbatim at the point of the breach. The corpus is therefore neither unaware nor approving: it bars, records the breach as a breach, and continues the line through it.

9.4 What Israel holds is recorded as received, with the source named

Four transfers, four foreign sources, none concealed. **A standing priestly order** from Melchizedek, Genesis 14:18-20, made permanent at Psalm 110:4. **A divine title**, *'El 'Elyon qoneh shamayim wa-'areš*, spoken by that priest at 14:19 and taken onto Abram's own oath with the Name appended at 14:22. **An administrative procedure**, the delegated judiciary of Exodus 18:13-23, with 18:24's *wa-yishma' Mosheh le-qol ḥoteno wa-ya'as kol 'asher 'amar*. **The sanctuary's ground, be-goren**

'Ornan ha-Yevusi at 2 Chronicles 3:1, **bought and not seized**: 2 Samuel 24:24's *lo' ki qano 'eqneh me-'otekha bi-meḥir, we-lo' 'a'aleh la-YHWH 'elohay 'olot ḥinnam*.

The verb at Genesis 14:20 lacks an explicit subject and the reading is contested; **this article takes no side**, because Psalm 110:4 settles whose order it is independently of who handed whom a tenth.

10. The removability result

Applied under §2.2, six substantive contents survive the strip.

Table 3 Six substantive contents surviving the removal of the royal figure	
Content	Anchor, no figure in the clause
Covenant fidelity	Deut 30:19-20; 10:12-13
Subordination of power to the teaching	Deut 17:18-20; 1 Sam 12:14-15
Refusal of self-certification	Deut 13:2-6; 18:21-22; Prov 27:2; Jer 9:22-23
Hope preserved under collapse	Ezek 37:11; Lam 3:21-24; Jer 29:11-14
The justice-arc	Amos 5:24; Ps 72:12-14; Isa 1:17; Mic 6:8
The terminus	Deut 12:9; Josh 21:44; 1 Kgs 8:56; 1 Chr 22:9; Ezek 37:14; Ps 95:11; Isa 11:9; Isa 2:4

What fails the strip is the act-layer, the gathering, the rebuilding, the restoration of offices. And **the corpus subordinates that layer grammatically wherever it states it**:

Deuteronomy 30:3-5 gathers and 30:6 circumcises the heart *le-ma'an hayyekha*; Ezekiel 36:24-28 gathers, sprinkles, gives the new heart, and lands on *wi-hyitem li le-'am wa-'anokhi 'ehyeh lakhem le-'elohim*; Ezekiel 37:21-23 lands on the same clause, with 37:14 supplying the terminus in *we-hinnaḥti*.

The result is therefore not that the acts are unreal. It is that the corpus files them as road and states the destination separately.

Two disciplinary notes. **The test is not vacuous on this corpus:** a whole class fails it, which is a cut and not a pass. And **the classification of passages by index-type is an instrument of this article and not a property claimed of the text;** the corpus supplies the members, the article supplies the sorting.

11. Positioning

Table 4 Prior positions and this article's relation to each		
Position	Representative form	Relation to this article
<i>Menuḥah</i> as land-gift, with an unresolved already-and-not-yet between Joshua and Psalm 95	von Rad 1933 and the literature following it	This article is downstream of it. The seam is not claimed as new. What is added is the removability criterion and the resulting sort of the royal material as means
The monarchy tension resolved by source division into pro- and anti-monarchic strands	classical source criticism on 1 Sam 8-12	No position taken. The article treats the final form's retention of both as the datum, which is compatible with any compositional account of how it got there
Messianism as a comparatively late development not present in the pre-exilic royal texts	Mowinckel and successors	Compatible. The escalation sequence redescribes the same material by content and commits to no dating beyond the corpus's own narrative order
The royal and future-royal texts as the interpretive centre toward which the corpus tends	much confessional and canonical-critical reading	Directly opposed at the sorting, though not on the reality or importance of the material. The article argues the corpus itself subordinates the acts to a state it names independently
The sabbath as institution and sign, studied on its own	the extensive sabbath literature	Adjacent. This article's interest is in <i>menuḥah</i> as the promise's terminus rather than in sabbath observance as such, and it connects the two only through the root-field of §3.1
Isa 6:9-10 as a hardening motif to be explained theologically or redactionally	the hardening literature	Used differently. The article takes 6:9-10 with Deut 29:3, Isa 42:19, and Jer 6:16 as a converging diagnosis of reception rather than as a problem about divine intent

12. Falsification

Three criteria, each executable inside the Hebrew Bible, each stated with its present result.

F1. The terminus criterion. If the *menuḥah*, *šqt*, knowledge-condition, and war-cessation clauses are systematically **figure-indexed**, requiring a royal or eschatological agent in the clause or its immediate pericope, then §3 fails and the frame is not removable. **Executable:** run the *nwh*, *menuḥah*, and *šqt* concordance across the corpus, isolate terminal-position sites, and count agent-requirements. **Present result:** the sites listed carry no such requirement and four of them name non-royal deliverers. **This concordance is not yet executed in full and the article's terminal strength is capped at that debt (§13).**

F2. The concession criterion. If the corpus at any point **withdraws** the concession rather than re-issuing it at higher intensity, §5 and §7 both fail. **Executable:** search for any withdrawal formula. **Present result:** none exists; 2 Samuel 7:15 explicitly bars withdrawal and Hosea 13:11's taking is a judgment on a king rather than a repeal.

F3. The receiver criterion. If Deuteronomy 29:3, Psalm 95:11, Isaiah 6:9-10, and Isaiah 42:19-20 can be read as locating the failure in an **absent or withheld** terminus rather than a deficient receiver, §4 dissolves and §7 acquires a different and possibly adequate explanation. **Executable:** identify the subject of the deficiency in each. **Present result:** all four place it in the heart, the ears, the eyes, or the hearing.

A limit case, stated because it is the sharpest available. If a royal figure of the expected kind arrived, what in this article would fall? **Nothing.** §3 would still have a terminus named in the settling-root and delivered twice by ordinary agents; §4 would still have the deficit at the receiver in five texts; §5 would still have the bill printed in advance; §6 would still have the seat conferred. **The article argues that the figure is a means, and a means that arrives is a means that has arrived.** No claim here rests on non-arrival, and none predicts arrival.

13. Limits

The principal debt is a census. The *nwh*, *menuḥah*, and *šqt* concordance across the whole corpus, with terminal-position sites isolated and the marked-to-unmarked ratio printed, has not been

executed. Section 3 rests on six settling-root sites within a larger field, and **the ratio is a fact to be executed rather than asserted**. Everything in this article is capped at that.

Two philological points are contested and are carried as contested, not silently resolved: the referent of *soferim* and the parsing of 'asah at Jeremiah 8:8, and the subject of *wa-yitten* at Genesis 14:20. In each case the argument is constructed so that it holds under either reading.

The index-type classification is an instrument, not a finding about the text.

The escalation sequence is ordered by content and not by date, and any reader who takes it as a compositional claim has taken more than is offered.

14. Conclusion

The Hebrew Bible names the terminus of its promise in a root whose sense is settlement and not recuperation, states it as achieved under Joshua and announced under Solomon and held four times in the book of Judges, and records that it was not entered. It locates the failure of entry in the hearing, the heart, the eyes, and a refusal spoken by the hearers themselves, and nowhere in a gift withheld. It grants a visible monarchy against an itemized prosecution and a notice that the resulting outcry will go unanswered, seats the king on a throne it repeatedly calls God's, and subordinates the occupant to a written law he does not author. When kings fail it re-issues the grant at higher intensity, eight

times, without ever withdrawing it and without ever pointing back to the terminus it had already named.

What the corpus does not do is confuse the two. It states the destination in clauses containing no figure and no date, and it places the acts of gathering and restoration under purpose clauses whose object is the state those acts move toward. **The road is real and the corpus commands it. It is simply not the destination, and the corpus says so in its own grammar.**

That the shoot grows and the stump dies in the dust, that the persisting part is the root and the trigger is water already in the ground, that the paths are ancient and the instruction is to walk them and the answer recorded is *we will not walk in it*: these are the corpus's own images for a gift that stands and is not taken up.

The rest was given. It was not entered. And on the corpus's own account the failure was never in the giving.

References

Full bibliography to be supplied on submission. Principal interlocutors: von Rad on *menuḥah* and the rest-motif in the Deuteronomistic material; Noth on the Deuteronomistic History; Mowinckel on the development of messianic expectation; the source-critical literature on 1 Samuel 8-12; Zimmerli on Ezekiel 34; the hardening literature on Isaiah 6:9-10; and the discussion of Jeremiah 8:8 and the scribal office. Hebrew citations follow BHS; transliteration is broad and academic.